

Week 2 Narrative Report: Synesthetic Learning Project

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Instead of continuing with theoretical planning, this week was focused on practical setup and getting the datasets ready for actual model development. Since the project depends heavily on pairing emotional audio with abstract artwork, the first major step was to ensure that both datasets were complete and properly arranged. Our team agreed that Week 2 would revolve around verifying the dataset contents, fixing inconsistencies, and preparing everything for the preprocessing stage.

My work this week centered on organizing and reviewing the data resources. I started by checking the folder layouts for both the audio and artwork collections, taking note of missing files and irregular label patterns. This helped the group identify which parts needed restructuring before any preprocessing could be done. I also assisted by counting and recording how many samples each emotion category had within the image dataset, which made it easier to spot uneven distributions across classes.

For metadata preparation, I helped clean up the information generated from the automatic parsers. This involved checking label names, adjusting inconsistent entries, and ensuring that the format matched across both modalities. I also participated in reviewing the draft emotion alignment chart, suggesting revisions to certain categories that did not match well between the audio and visual datasets. These adjustments helped finalize a more coherent emotional label system for the project.

In order to help the team visualize the current state of the datasets, I worked on basic graphical summaries. I organized the distribution counts into readable bar charts and compiled them into a document the team could reference while planning preprocessing strategies. These summaries highlighted which emotions might require augmentation or rebalancing in the next steps.

By focusing on data organization, metadata correction, and label refinement, my contribution this week helped prepare the groundwork needed for the model training pipeline. The cleaned and structured datasets will make it easier for the group to move into feature extraction and the development of the multimodal learning framework in the upcoming weeks.